

number of particles go up, you not only take away less wood, you will also be left with a smoother finish.

Do You Know the Drill?

Having so far spoken about the destructive aspect of woodworking and carpentry, it's time to move on to the additive aspect. Unless you're the kind of person who's into monolithic sculptures, there will eventually come a time when you will find the need to join two pieces of wood.

While an entire FastTrack can be devoted to the detailed art of wood joints, the simplest way you can fasten two pieces of wood together is to use glue in combination with a nail or a screw. Between nails and screws, nails are the stronger of the two, while screws give you a more aesthetic appeal. Screws will also fasten two pieces of wood better, but also tend to be more brittle.

Whether you're using a screw or a nail, if you don't want your wood to split, you should always start with a pilot hole. While in the case of a nail, the pilot hole will only be a little indent on the surface of the wood that serves as a guide, for a screw, the pilot hole should be a little deep and narrower than the screw itself.

The best way to achieve this is to grab a drill with the narrowest drill bit attached to it. Line it up next to the screw and measure how long the screw is and use a piece of tape as a marker for the adequate depth.

Use a hole punch or a nail to make an indent in the wood and line your drill up against the wood. If you're using an electric drill, remember to place one hand under the 'muzzle' if you're drilling parallel to the ground or place your hand on the butt of the drill if you're



Now you know the drill